

Chapter - 8

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Candidate Key

→ Minimal Super Key

ID, name, address

ID

ID, name

ID, name, address

Super Key

Super Key

ID, name

Not Candidate Key

ID → Candidate Key

A	B	C
1	x	y
2	a	b
3	c	d

Functional

$A \rightarrow BC$

Dependency

→ (stu-id, stu-name, stu-address,

course-name, prereq-name, marks, grade)

Functional
Dependency

ID → name, address

course → prereq

marks → grade

$A \rightarrow B$ ✗

If A is repeated

B should have same value

$B \rightarrow A$ ✓

A	B
1	3
1	5
2	6
3	7

course & prereq

$A \rightarrow B$ ✓

$B \rightarrow A$ ✓

T ₁	A	B
T ₀	1	3
	1	3
	2	6
	3	7

*

Functional Dependency

Let R be a relational schema
Where $\alpha \subset R$, $B \subset R$. then
Functional Dependency, $\alpha \rightarrow B$
holds if and only if any two
tuple T_1 & T_2 agree on α .
they must agree on B .

→ Purpose of Functional Dependency
— To identify redundancy & reduce it

→ An Attribute is not required to be a Key for functional dependency

* Closure Set of Functional Dependency

Set of all Functional Dependency on a Relation → Closure Set

Set F of Functional Dependency
find F^+ (Additional Functional Dependency)

$A \rightarrow B$
 $B \rightarrow C \Rightarrow A \rightarrow C$

$A \rightarrow BC$

$A \rightarrow B$

$A \rightarrow C$

* Armstrong's Axioms

$\alpha \Rightarrow$ Set of Attributes:

$$\beta \subseteq \alpha$$

$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ holds

① Reflexivity

$$\alpha \rightarrow \alpha$$

(If you know A, you know A
you need not determine A (if B))

$$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$$

$$\beta \rightarrow \alpha$$

α determines β

② Augmentation.

If $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ holds, γ (another attribute)

$$\gamma\alpha \rightarrow \gamma\beta \text{ holds.}$$

③ Transitivity.

If $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ holds,
 $\beta \rightarrow \gamma$ holds

then $\alpha \rightarrow \gamma$ will hold.

④ Union

If $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ holds
 $\alpha \rightarrow \gamma$ holds.

then $\alpha \rightarrow \beta\gamma$ will hold.

⑤ Decomposition

If $X \rightarrow BY$ holds
 then $X \rightarrow B$ & $X \rightarrow Y$ holds

⑥ Pseudo-Transitivity

If $X \rightarrow B$ holds,
 $B \rightarrow Y$ holds,
 then $X \rightarrow Y$ will hold.

Ex -

$$A \rightarrow B$$

$$A \rightarrow C$$

$$CG \rightarrow H$$

$$CG \rightarrow I$$

$$B \rightarrow H$$

$$A \rightarrow BC$$

$$CG \rightarrow HI$$

$$A \rightarrow H$$

$$AG \rightarrow I$$

$$AG \rightarrow H$$

All found $\rightarrow F^+$
 $\hookrightarrow$ Closure set

* Closure of Attributes

$$A \rightarrow B$$

$$B \rightarrow D$$

$$C \rightarrow DE$$

$$CD \rightarrow AB$$

$$A^+ = \{A, B, D\}$$

$$C^+ = \{C, D, E, A, B\}$$

$\hookrightarrow$ Key (super)

F.D

S

 $A \rightarrow B$ $A \rightarrow C$ $CG \rightarrow H$ $CG \rightarrow P$ $B \rightarrow H$

y

 $AG^+ \Rightarrow AG BCHP$

Algorithm

 α^+ result = α ;

repeat

for each F.D $B \rightarrow Y$

begin

if $B \subseteq \text{result}$ result = result $\cup Y$

end

Until (result does not change)

result = AG result = $AG \cup B = AGB$ result = $AGB \cup C = AGBC$ result = $AGBC \cup H = AGBCH$ result = $AGBCH \cup P = AGBCHP$

(Application of Algorithm)

Application is used to

→ Find Primary Key (is α Super Key)→ To check Functional Dependency
 $\alpha \rightarrow B$, holds(if α^+ gives B then true)Ex - Here $AG \rightarrow B$ ✓

Set of all Attribute is always
Candidate Key.

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- To compute F^+

* How to find Candidate Key using
Closure.

$\{A, B, C, D\}$

Start with 1 Element Closure
then Upward.

$A \rightarrow B$

$B \rightarrow C$

$C \rightarrow D$

$D \rightarrow A$

$A^+ \Rightarrow ABCD$

$B^+ \Rightarrow BCDA$

$C^+ \Rightarrow CDAB$

$D^+ \Rightarrow DABC$

Don't check Further

A, B, C, D are Candidate
All other are Super Key
they can not be Candidate

→ $R(ABCDEF)$

(i) CD

$C \rightarrow F$

(ii) EC

$E \rightarrow A$

(iii) AE

$EC \rightarrow D$

(iv) AC

$A \rightarrow B$

$$CD^+ \Rightarrow C D F$$

$$EC^+ \Rightarrow E C D A B F \rightarrow E^+ \Rightarrow E A B$$

$$C^+ \Rightarrow C F$$

$$AE^+ \Rightarrow A E B$$

None of them
is super key

$$AC^+ \Rightarrow A C B F$$

so EC is candidate key

Short cut

$$X \Rightarrow (A B C D E F)$$

on Right side

so C, E cannot be derived.
so they should be on Left side
so check

$$CE^+$$

then

$$C^+$$

$$E^+$$

You get your Answer

Q. R C E F G H I J K L M N

$$EF \rightarrow G$$

$$EH \rightarrow K L$$

$$F \rightarrow I J$$

$$K \rightarrow M$$

$$L \rightarrow N$$

$$E^+ \Rightarrow E$$

$$EH^+ \Rightarrow E H K L M N$$

$$F^+ \Rightarrow F I J$$

$$EF^+ \Rightarrow E F G I J$$

$$H^+ \Rightarrow H$$

$$HF^+ \Rightarrow H F I J$$

$$E'FH^+ \Rightarrow EFHGJIKLMN$$

$\hookrightarrow$ Minimal Super Key
 $\downarrow$
 Candidate Key.

In Short Cut
 Don't check for subcel (for CK)

$$Q \cdot R(ABCD)$$

$$AB \rightarrow CD$$

$$D \rightarrow A$$

$$B^+ \Rightarrow B \quad (\text{Not sufficient } B \text{ must be there})$$

$$AB^+ \Rightarrow ABCD$$

$$BD^+ \Rightarrow BDAC$$

$$Q \cdot R(AB CDEF)$$

$$AB \rightarrow C$$

$$C \rightarrow D$$

$$B \rightarrow AE$$

$$BF^+ \Rightarrow BFAECD$$

$$BF \Rightarrow$$

$$Q \cdot R(ABCD)$$

$$AB \rightarrow CD$$

$$C \rightarrow A$$

$$D \rightarrow B$$

AB is Candidate Key
(Shortcut not possible here)